



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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The good choice: Fruits should have an appealing hue that matches their variety. For instance, ripe bananas have a yellow skin with brown speckles. GETTYIMAGES

A NUTRIENT-RICH ADVENTURE

Here's a guide to selecting the freshest and most flavourful fruits and veggies for a **vibrant and healthy** lifestyle.

The path to a healthy lifestyle begins with choices we make at the market. Consuming fresh and vibrant veggies and fruits is not only a key component of a balanced diet but also an enjoyable culinary experience. In this guide, we explore the art of choosing and buying a variety of veggies and fruits, ensuring you bring home the best that nature has to offer.

Understanding seasonality

One of the fundamental aspects of selecting high-quality produce is understanding the concept of seasonality. Different fruits and vegetables thrive in different seasons and buying them during their peak season ensures optimal freshness, flavour, and nutritional value. Familiarise yourself with the local growing seasons or consult with seasonal produce guides like nutritionists to make informed choices.

Assessing appearance and colour

Visual cues play a crucial role in determining the freshness and quality. When selecting vegetables, look for vibrant colours and firm texture. Avoid those with signs of wilting, discolouration, or bruising. For example, when buying spinach, avoid those that are

wilted and go for dark green and crisp ones. For bell peppers, opt for firm and brightly coloured ones.

Fruits, on the other hand, should have an appealing hue that matches their variety. For instance, ripe bananas have a yellow skin with brown speckles, while a ripe watermelon should sound hollow when tapped and have a uniform, deep green colour. Pay attention to any blemishes, mold, or soft spots, as these could indicate overripeness or spoilage.

Feel the texture

The texture of fruits and vegetables provides valuable information about their ripeness and freshness. When choosing vegetables, aim for a crisp texture and avoid any that feel limp or rubbery. For instance, fresh carrots should snap easily, and cucumbers should be firm without any soft spots. For fruits, gently squeeze them to assess their ripeness. A ripe avocado yields slightly to gentle pressure, while a firm one needs